GOVERNMENT OF ANDHRA PRADESH

Women Empowerment & Livelihood Schemes
Comprehensive Comparative Guide: YSR Cheyutha, Kapu Nestham, and EBC Nestham

1. Executive Overview & Policy Framework

The Government of Andhra Pradesh has structured a triad of saturation-mode Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) welfare initiatives targeting mature women in the critical middle-age bracket of 45 to 60 years. Recognizing that women in this age cohort often face employment vulnerabilities and credit constraints, these programs provide multi-year non-repayable financial subventions. Beneficiaries are encouraged to deploy these grants into sustainable micro-entrepreneurship—such as dairy farming, retail grocery, weaving, and livestock rearing—supplemented by state corporate partnerships with major FMCG and financial institutions.

2. Triad Scheme Comparison Profiles

YSR Cheyutha

- **Target Community:** SC, ST, BC, and Minority women.
- **Age Eligibility:** 45 to 60 Years.
- **Total Financial Grant:** Rs. 75,000.
- **Disbursement Tenure:** 4 Annual Installments (Rs. 18,750 per year).
- **Implementing Department:** SERP / Panchayati Raj & Rural Development.
- **Livelihood Tie-ups:** MoUs with Amul, ITC, HUL, Reliance, P&G.

Kapu Nestham

- **Target Community:** Kapu, Balija, Telaga, and Ontari sub-castes.
- **Age Eligibility:** 45 to 60 Years.
- **Total Financial Grant:** Rs. 75,000.
- **Disbursement Tenure:** 5 Annual Installments (Rs. 15,000 per year).
- **Implementing Department:** Backward Classes Welfare Dept. / Kapu Corp.
- **Livelihood Tie-ups:** Self-employment, small trade & dairy support.

EBC Nestham

- **Target Community:** Economically Backward Classes (OC/Upper Caste EBC).
- **Age Eligibility:** 45 to 60 Years.
- **Total Financial Grant:** Rs. 45,000.
- **Disbursement Tenure:** 3 Annual Installments (Rs. 15,000 per year).
- **Implementing Department:** Backward Classes Welfare Dept. / EBC Wing.

3. Standard Eligibility & Income Criteria

To ensure targeting integrity across all three programs, the Government applies a uniform socio-economic screening criteria structure:

- **Domicile:** Permanent resident of Andhra Pradesh holding a valid state-registered Aadhaar card.
- **Gender & Age Verification:** Exclusively for women aged between 45 and 60 years as certified by school records, birth certificates, or voter photo identity cards.
- **Family Income Ceilings:** Total annual household income must not exceed Rs. 1,20,000 in rural areas and Rs. 1,44,000 in urban areas.
- **Landholding Limits:** Total family agricultural landholding must be less than 3.00 acres of wet land, or less than 10.00 acres of dry land, or combined wet and dry land not exceeding 10.00 acres.
- **Electricity Consumption:** Domestic monthly electricity consumption of the family must not exceed 300 units per month.
- **Four-Wheeler Ownership:** No family member should own a four-wheeler (autos, tractors, and commercial taxis are specifically exempt).
- **Municipal Property Restriction:** Family must not own residential or commercial property in municipal limits with a built-up area exceeding 750 sq. ft.
- **Government Employment Exclusion:** No family member should be a regular government employee or regular pensioner (sanitation workers' families are expressly exempt).
- **Tax Payee Disqualification:** No member of the beneficiary's immediate household can be an Income Tax payee.

4. Individual Scheme Deep Dive

4.1 YSR Cheyutha Scheme

Target Demographics: Exclusively dedicated to women from Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST), Backward Classes (BC), and Recognized Minority communities.

Financial Structure: Total cash transfer of Rs. 75,000 paid in four equal tranches of Rs. 18,750 per year directly into the woman's NPCI-seeded bank account.

Livelihood Ecosystem: Unlike conventional unconditional cash transfers, YSR Cheyutha establishes an institutional livelihood link via SERP and MEPMA. The government entered into corporate MoUs with industrial leaders. Beneficiaries are provided institutional bank tie-ups to establish mini-supermarkets, retail grocery outlets, and livestock units.

4.2 YSR Kapu Nestham Scheme

Target Demographics: Designed specifically for underprivileged women belonging to the Kapu, Balija, Telaga, and Ontari sub-castes across Andhra Pradesh.

Financial Structure: Cumulative grant of Rs. 75,000 distributed across five annual installments of Rs. 15,000 each year.

Objective: Bridges historical credit disparities among women in agricultural and artisanal sub-castes who do not fall under SC/ST/BC reservations. The state-run Kapu Welfare and Development Corporation oversees the program to foster micro-enterprises and household solvency.

4.3 YSR EBC Nestham Scheme

Target Demographics: Directed at economically impoverished women belonging to non-reserved Other Castes (OC) / Economically Backward Classes (EBC) (e.g., Reddy, Kamma, Arya Vysya, Kshatriya, Brahmin, and other non-Kapu upper-caste EWS).

Financial Structure: Financial assistance of Rs. 45,000 disbursed over three consecutive annual tranches of Rs. 15,000 per year.

Strategic Value: Resolves welfare exclusion by ensuring that poverty, rather than caste privilege, determines access to state empowerment subventions.

5. Mandatory Verification Checklist

- **Aadhaar Card:** Issued by UIDAI (Must be linked with active mobile number) for biometric e-KYC and identity verification.
- **Integrated Caste Certificate:** Issued by Revenue Dept. / MeeSeva to authenticate SC, ST, BC, Kapu, or OC sub-caste.
- **Income Certificate:** Issued by Revenue Dept. or proven via White Rice Ration Card to establish compliance with income caps.
- **Age Proof Certificate:** 10th SSC Marksheet, Voter ID, or Birth Certificate to ensure the beneficiary falls strictly within the 45-60 range.
- **Bank Passbook Details:** Nationalized or Scheduled Commercial Bank account linked to Aadhaar and NPCI for Direct Benefit Transfer.
- **Property & Power Declaration:** Self-declaration validated by Sachivalayam confirming electricity and land limits are met.

6. Step-by-Step Application & Social Audit Workflow

- **Step 1 - Registration:** Apply online via citizen login on Navasakam Portal or submit physical documents at the local Sachivalayam.
- **Step 2 - Field Scrutiny:** Welfare and Education Assistant conducts physical and digital verification at the household.